

Changyeon Kim

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RESEARCH INTEREST

My research focuses on efficient and effective post-training for robot foundation models. I develop scalable learning, reliable evaluation, and continual adaptation methods for robots that improve through real-world experience.

EDUCATION

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)

Ph.D. in Artificial Intelligence

Advisor: **Kimin Lee** and **Jinwoo Shin**

Daejeon, S.Korea

Feb. 2022 - Oct. 2026

Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology (KAIST)

B.Sc. in Computer Science and Mathematics (minor)

Daejeon, S.Korea

Mar. 2016 - Feb. 2021

WORK EXPERIENCE

NVIDIA Seattle Robotics Lab

Research Intern (Host: **Yijie Guo** and **Yashraj Narang**)

Seattle, WA, USA

May. 2026 - Sep. 2026

The University of Texas at Austin

Visiting Scholar (Host: **Yuke Zhu**)

Austin, TX, USA

Sep. 2024 - Jul. 2025

Kakao

Machine Learning Engineer at Recommendation Team

Seongnam, S.Korea

Dec. 2020 - Feb. 2022

PUBLICATIONS

C: Conference, W: Workshop, P: Preprint, *: Equal contribution

- [P3] **Changyeon Kim**, Kimin Lee, Yashraj Narang, Yijie Guo. ACCRUE: Continual Off-Policy Reinforcement Learning for Robot Foundation Models. Under review at IEEE International Conference on Robotics & Automation (**ICRA**) 2027. (Available upon request)
- [P2] **Changyeon Kim**, Yekyung Nah, Kimin Lee. RACE: Calibrated Cumulative Scoring for Rollout-Free Checkpoint Selection. Under review at IEEE International Conference on Robotics & Automation (**ICRA**) 2027. (Available upon request)
- [C12] Yonghoon Dong, Kyungmin Lee, **Changyeon Kim**, Jaehyuk Kim, Jinwoo Shin. **Trust Region Q Adjoint Matching**. Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (**NeurIPS**), 2026.
- [C11] Huihan Liu, **Changyeon Kim**, Bo Liu, Minghuan Liu, Yuke Zhu. **Pretrained Vision-Language-Action Models are Surprisingly Resistant to Forgetting in Continual Learning**. International Conference on Machine Learning (**ICML**), 2026. Designated as **oral paper (168 / 23918 = 0.7%)**
- [C10] Taeyoung Kim, Jimin Lee, Myungkyu Koo, Dongyoung Kim, Kyungmin Lee, **Changyeon Kim**, Younggyo Seo, Jinwoo Shin. **Contrastive Representation Regularization for Vision-Language-Action Models**. International Conference on Machine Learning (**ICML**), 2026.

- [C9] Suchae Jeong, Jaehwi Song, Haeone Lee, Hanna Kim, Jian Kim, Dongjun Lee, Dong Kyu Shin, **Changyeon Kim**, Dongyoon Hahm, Woogyol Jin, Juheon Choi, Kimin Lee. **Learning Multi-View Spatial Reasoning from Cross-View Relations**. The IEEE/CVF Conference on Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (**CVPR**), 2026.
- [C8] **Changyeon Kim**, Haeone Lee, Younggyo Seo, Kimin Lee, Yuke Zhu. **DEAS: DETached value learning with Action Sequence for Scalable Offline RL**. International Conference on Learning Representations (**ICLR**), 2026.
- [C7] Suhyeok Jang, Dongyoung Kim, **Changyeon Kim**, Youngsuk Kim, Jinwoo Shin. **Verifier-free Test-Time Sampling for Vision Language Action Models**. International Conference on Learning Representations (**ICLR**), 2026.
- [C6] Myungkyu Koo, Daewon Choi, Taeyoung Kim, Kyungmin Lee, **Changyeon Kim**, Younggyo Seo, Jinwoo Shin. **HAMLET: Switch Your Vision-Language-Action Model into a History-Aware Policy**. International Conference on Learning Representations (**ICLR**), 2026.
- [C5] Juyong Lee, Taywon Min, Minyong Ahn, Dongyoon Hahm, Haeone Lee, **Changyeon Kim**, Kimin Lee. **B-MoCA: Benchmarking Mobile Device Control Agents across Diverse Configurations**. Conference on Life-long Learning Agents (**CoLLAs**), 2025. ICLR 2024 Workshop on Generative Models for Decision Making (**GenAI4DM**), **Spotlight**
- [C4] **Changyeon Kim**, Minho Heo, Doohyun Lee, Jinwoo Shin, Honglak Lee, Kimin Lee, Joseph J Lim. **Subtask-Aware Visual Reward Learning from Segmented Demonstrations**. International Conference on Learning Representations (**ICLR**), 2025.
- [C3] **Changyeon Kim**, Younggyo Seo, Hao Liu, Lisa Lee, Jinwoo Shin, Honglak Lee, Kimin Lee. **Guide Your Agent with Adaptive Multimodal Rewards**. Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (**NeurIPS**), 2023. **Finalist**, Qualcomm Innovation Fellowship Korea 2024
- [C2] **Changyeon Kim***, Jongjin Park*, Jinwoo Shin, Honglak Lee, Pieter Abbeel, Kimin Lee. **Preference Transformer: Modeling Human Preferences using Transformers for RL**. International Conference on Learning Representations (**ICLR**), 2023.
- [W1] **Changyeon Kim***, Junsu Kim*, Younggyo Seo, Kimin Lee, Honglak Lee, Jinwoo Shin. **Dynamics-Augmented Decision Transformer for Offline Dynamics Generalization**. NeurIPS 2022 Workshop on Offline Reinforcement Learning (NeurIPSW)
- [C1] Gabriel Lima, **Changyeon Kim**, Seungho Ryu, Chihyoung Jeon, Meeyoung Cha. **Collecting the Public Perception of AI and Robot Rights**. Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (**CSCW**), 2020.
- [P1] Hojoon Lee, Dongyoon Hwang, Sunghwan Hong, **Changyeon Kim**, Seungryong Kim, Jaegul Choo. **MOI-Mixer: Improving MLP-Mixer with Multi Order Interactions in Sequential Recommendation**. ArXiv Preprint.

INVITED TALKS

Efficient Post-Training for Robotic Foundation Models in Real-World Deployment

CMU LeCAR Lab (Advisor: Guanya Shi)

Sep. 2026

Guide Your Agent with Adaptive Multimodal Rewards

LG AI Research @ NeurIPS (2023)

Dec. 2023

HONORS & AWARDS

Silver Reviewer Award International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)	2026 Seoul, S.Korea
Notable Reviewer International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)	2025 Singapore
Finalist Qualcomm Innovation Fellowship Korea	2024 Seoul, S.Korea
Travel Award Conference on Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)	2023 New Orleans, USA
Scholarship KAIST-Google Partnership Program	2023 Daejeon, S.Korea
East Asia Student Travel Grant Google	2023 New Orleans, USA
Travel Award International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)	2023 Kigali, Rwanda
Dean's List (Fall Semester) Department of Engineering, KAIST	2019 Daejeon, S.Korea
Line Scholarship (Fall Semester) School of Computing, KAIST	2019 Daejeon, S.Korea
National Science and Engineering Scholarship Korea Ministry of Science and ICT	2017 - 19 Daejeon, S.Korea

ACADEMIC SERVICES

Conference Reviewer: ICML, NeurIPS, ICLR, CoRL, AAAI, RSS, ECCV, RA-L
Workshop Reviewer: ICML Frontiers4LCD 2023, CoRL MRM-D 2024, NeurIPS WRM 2026

MENTORING

Yonghoon Dong: now PhD student at KAIST (2026.03 - 2026.09)
Myungkyu Koo: now PhD student at KAIST (2025.08 - 2026.01)
Taeyoung Kim: now PhD student at KAIST (2025.08 - 2026.01)
Suhyeok Jang: now PhD student at KAIST (2025.08 - 2026.01)
Namgyu Kim: now BS student at POSTECH (2026.01 - 2026.09)

REFERENCE

Kimin Lee: Assistant Professor at KAIST (kiminlee@kaist.ac.kr)
Jinwoo Shin: Full Professor at KAIST (jinwoos@kaist.ac.kr)
Yuke Zhu: Associate Professor at UT Austin & Director at NVIDIA GEAR (yukez@cs.utexas.edu)
Yijie Guo: Research Scientist at NVIDIA Seattle Robotics Lab (yijieg@nvidia.com)